



City of Cambridge

POR 2026-145
FIRST IN COUNCIL
August 3, 2026

COUNCILLOR ZUSY
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
COUNCILLOR NOLAN

- WHEREAS: The City keeps track of some tree related permits on its Open Data Portal, but it's hard to navigate [[link:https://data.cambridgema.gov/Public-Works/Tree-Removal-Permits/vj95-me7d/about_data](https://data.cambridgema.gov/Public-Works/Tree-Removal-Permits/vj95-me7d/about_data)]; and
- WHEREAS: Critical data fields – such as “Number of Trees” and “Reason for Removal” – are frequently left blank, preventing clear compilation of total number of significant and exceptional trees removed; and
- WHEREAS: The City has long celebrated its tree canopy and, in 2018, commissioned highly respected landscape architects Reed Hilderbrand to conduct an Urban Forest Master Plan [[link:https://www.cambridgema.gov/departments/publicworks/initiatives/urbanforestmasterplan](https://www.cambridgema.gov/departments/publicworks/initiatives/urbanforestmasterplan)] to ensure the forest's robust health; now therefore be it
- ORDERED: That the City Manager, working in collaboration with the Urban Forestry Department, Inspectional Services and IT, be and hereby is requested to devise a fuller, easier to navigate public accounting system that is searchable by neighborhood and explicitly records:
1. Tree removals categorized by project type and/or reason for removal
 2. Total count of significant and exceptional trees lost per permit; and
 3. Potential Critical Root Zone impacts on preserved on-site trees, adjacent private trees, and public city street and park trees; and be it further
- ORDERED: That this tracking system include an automated monthly public reporting summary detailing tree removal permits, number of trees removed, and project associations dating back to 2023; and be it further
- ORDERED: That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to report back to the City Council regarding improved tree loss accounting and reporting systems by October 1, 2026.

A true copy;

ATTEST:-

Paula M. Crane,
Interim City Clerk



City of Cambridge

That the City Manager is requested to report back to the City Council regarding improved tree loss accounting and reporting systems by October 1, 2026.